

LESSON 1 | REVISED STUDENT NOTES

Professional Lobby Communication

專業大堂首次接觸及訪客應對

First Contact, Clarification & Visitor Handling | 90 minutes

Lesson outcomes 課堂目標

OPEN	CLARIFY	VERIFY	EXPLAIN	DIRECT / CLOSE
Greet + offer help	Ask for missing details	Confirm + check	Say what happens next	Give next step + close

Sounding Professional

核心句式: 自然、完整、有禮貌

Function	Useful workplace expressions
Open the conversation	1. Good morning. Welcome to Three Garden Road. How may I assist you today? 2. Good afternoon. Customer Services Counter. What can I help you with?
Clarify purpose / visitor details	1. May I ask the purpose of your visit? 2. Could I confirm which company you're visiting? 3. May I have the name of the person you're here to see? 4. Do you have an appointment, or are you making a delivery?
Repair unclear communication	1. I'm sorry, I didn't catch the company name. Could you say it again a little more slowly? 2. Would you mind spelling your surname for me? 3. If I understood you correctly, you're here to see Ms Chan at 10:30. Is that right?
Wait / verify	1. Please allow me a moment to verify the appointment with the tenant's office. 2. Would you mind waiting in the reception area while I check? 3. Thank you for your patience. I'll update you as soon as I hear back.
Explain a limitation + offer an action	1. I'm afraid I'm unable to grant access until the visit has been confirmed. 2. What I can do is contact the office and let them know you've arrived.

Grammar focus for professional tone 語法重點

Structure	Example + note
Indirect questions	May I ask who you are visiting? (No question-word inversion after "May I ask...".)
Polite modals	Could I confirm...? / Would you mind waiting...? Use modals to soften requests.
Present perfect	The appointment hasn't been confirmed yet. Useful for an unfinished current situation.
Once / if clauses	Once I have confirmation, I can direct you to the correct lift.
Polite negative	I'm afraid I'm unable to... State the restriction, then offer what you can do.

Mini glossary 小詞庫

verify 核實 | host 接待人／被訪者 | grant access 批准進入 | reception area 接待區 | confidential 機密 |
 proceed 前往

FULL SITUATIONAL DIALOGUE 1

Confirmed Appointment, Missing Details

情境一：有預約，但資料需要核實 - Situation: **A visitor has a confirmed meeting.**

Listen, check only missing details, **confirm** key information, and **explain** the next step.

Security Officer	Good morning. Welcome to Three Garden Road. How may I assist you today?
Visitor	Morning. I have a 10:30 meeting with Vivian Chan at Bright Star Consulting.
Security Officer	Certainly. May I have your name and company, please?
Visitor	Daniel Roberts, from Eastgate Partners.
Security Officer	Thank you, Mr Roberts . Could I also confirm the floor listed in your meeting invitation?
Visitor	It says the 23rd floor.
Security Officer	Great. If I understood you correctly , that's Vivian Chan, Bright Star Consulting, 23rd floor, at 10:30. Is that correct?
Visitor	That's correct.
Security Officer	Thank you. Please allow me a moment to verify the appointment with their office. Would you mind waiting in the reception area?
Visitor	No problem.
Security Officer	Thank you for waiting, Mr Roberts. Your appointment has been confirmed. Please proceed to the visitor registration counter. My colleague will issue your pass and direct you to Lift B.
Visitor	Perfect. Thank you.
Security Officer	You're welcome. Enjoy your visit.

Quick upgrade - Noticing task 觀察任務

Rewrite "I go check." as one natural professional response:

Rewrite "What is your name?" as one natural professional response:

Rewrite "OK, I confirm a meeting." as one natural professional response:

Rewrite "What is the floor?" as one natural professional response:

Rewrite "Please go to the counter" as one natural professional response:

Rewrite "Let me repeat again" as one natural professional response:

Rewrite "How can I help you?" as one natural professional response:

FULL SITUATIONAL DIALOGUE 2

Unannounced Visitor Under Time Pressure

情境二：未有預約、訪客催促

Situation: The visitor says the **matter is urgent but has no appointment**. The officer must **stay calm, explain the access restriction, protect confidentiality** and offer a realistic alternative.

Visitor	Hi. I need to see Raymond Cheung at Sterling Asset Management. It's urgent.
Security Officer	Good afternoon. I understand it's urgent. May I ask whether Mr Cheung is expecting you today?
Visitor	No, but he knows who I am . I only need five minutes.
Security Officer	I see. May I have your name and company so I can contact his office?
Visitor	Elaine Foster, Westfield Advisory. Can I just go up? I'm already late.
Security Officer	I'm afraid I'm unable to grant access until the office confirms the visit. What I can do is call them now and let them know you're waiting.
Visitor	How long is that going to take?
Security Officer	It usually only takes a few minutes, but I don't want to promise a time before I reach them. Would you mind waiting by the Customer Services Counter?
Visitor	Fine, but please tell them it's confidential.
Security Officer	Certainly. I'll only say that you've arrived and would like to speak with Mr Cheung. I won't discuss the nature of your visit.
Visitor	Thank you.
Security Officer	You're welcome. I'll update you as soon as I hear back.

Note on language:

Waiting **in** the reception area | Wait **by** the Customer Services Counter

Why this response works 為甚麼有效

- Acknowledges the visitor's urgency **without agreeing to bypass the procedure.**
- **Explains the restriction calmly** and gives a practical alternative.
- **Avoids making a time promise** that the officer **cannot guarantee.**
- **Protects confidential information** while still contacting the tenant.

Quick upgrade - Noticing task 觀察任務

Rewrite "**Yeah, I know it is urgent.**" as one natural professional response:

Rewrite "**I will let you know / I will tell you**" as one natural professional response:

Rewrite "**I can't do this for you**" as one natural professional response:

Rewrite "**OK OK no problem**" as one natural professional response:

Rewrite "**Let you go inside**" as one natural professional response:

Rewrite "**I can only do xxxx**" as one natural professional response:

Rewrite "**Tell them you come**" as one natural professional response:

Rewrite "**It is very fast**" as one natural professional response:

Rewrite "**You come and find John Lee**" as one natural professional response:

Rewrite "**I won't tell people**" as one natural professional response:

Rewrite "**why you come**" as one natural professional response:

LISTENING & RESPONSE

Catch Details, Then React 聆聽及即時回應

1) record only what you actually hear. 2) If information is missing or unclear, ask a follow-up question instead of guessing.

Task A — Security log 保安記錄

Item	Your notes
Purpose of visit	_____
Visitor name + company	_____
Host / company to visit	_____
Time / floor	_____
Best next action	_____

Task B — Fast speech repair 聽不清楚時怎樣補救

Listen once. Write two details you caught, then say ONE clarification question you would use.

Detail 1: _____ Detail 2: _____

My clarification question: _____

Task C — React in five seconds 五秒內回應

Visitor says...	Your immediate response
"I'm here to see Ms Wong, but I can't remember the company name."	_____
"Sorry, I'm in a rush. Can I go straight up?"	_____
"My surname is Szczepanski."	_____
"I said 14th, not 40th."	_____

Teacher read-aloud script — students cover this box during the first listen

A: "Good afternoon. My name is Amelia Grant from Northbridge Analytics. I have a 2:15 appointment with Olivia Ho at Meridian Finance on the 18th floor."

Answer phrases:

- **Task B:** "Just to make sure I understood correctly, could you please repeat the company name and floor number?"
- **Task C1:** "No problem. May I have Ms Wong's full name, please? I'll check the directory and see if I can locate her office for you."
- **Task C2:** "I'm afraid I'm unable to grant access until the office confirms the visit. What I can do is call them now and let them know you're waiting."
- **Task C3:** "Thank you. I'm sorry, I didn't quite catch the spelling. Could you spell your surname for me, please?"
- **Task C4:** My apologies. Thank you for correcting me. Just to confirm, you said the 14th floor, is that correct?"

FULL SITUATIONAL DIALOGUE 3

Contradictory Floor Information

情境三：樓層資料不一致，需要核實

Situation: A visitor has come for a meeting, but the **floor number in the visitor's email does not match the building directory**.

Listen for the contradiction, **confirm** the important details, **avoid guessing**, and **explain** that you need to verify the correct location before allowing the visitor to proceed.

Security Officer	Good afternoon. Welcome to Three Garden Road. How may I assist you today?
Visitor	Hi. I'm here to see Anthony Lau at Apex Consulting.
Security Officer	Certainly. May I have your name, please?
Visitor	Sophia Flora. I have a meeting with Mr Lau this afternoon.
Security Officer	Thank you, Ms Flora. Could I confirm the floor with you?
Visitor	It says the 14th floor .
Security Officer	I see. There seems to be a discrepancy. Our building directory currently lists Apex Consulting on the 24th floor, rather than the 14th.
Visitor	Really? Are you sure the directory is up to date?
Security Officer	That's a good question. Let me contact Apex Consulting and confirm their current location.
Visitor	But my email definitely says the 14th floor.
Security Officer	I understand your concern. Just to confirm, you're here to see Mr Anthony Lau at Apex Consulting, and your email states the 14th floor. Is that correct?
Visitor	Yes, that's correct.
Security Officer	Thank you. Please allow me a moment to check with their office. Would you mind waiting in the reception area while I verify the floor?
Visitor	Sure. How long will it take?
Security Officer	It should only take a few minutes, but I'll update you as soon as I receive confirmation.
Visitor	All right. Thank you.
Security Officer	You're welcome, Ms Martin. Thank you for your patience.

Quick upgrade - Noticing task 觀察任務

Rewrite **"It is different."** as one natural professional response:

Rewrite **"The board says it is 4th floor for Company X"** as one natural professional response:

Rewrite **"I know"** as one natural professional response:

Rewrite **"I will tell you very fast"** as one natural professional response:

Pair Work: Manage the Visitor, Not Just the Sentence!

角色扮演:處理完整情境, 而非背誦單句

Work in pairs. 4 minutes per situation.

Student B **should not reveal all information** at once.

Student A **should ask only for what is missing**. Switch roles after each round.

Situation Card 1 — Scheduled visitor 情境卡一

Student A — Security Officer	Student B — Visitor
Your goals: • Open professionally. • Ask for missing visitor details. • Confirm appointment details. • Ask the visitor to wait while you verify. • Explain the next step and close politely.	Name: David Chan Company: Bright Star Ltd. Host: Ms Olivia Ho, Golden Finance Time: 2:15 p.m. Floor: 18th Extra challenge: Say your name and company quickly the first time.

Situation Card 2 — Unannounced urgent visitor 情境卡二

Student A — Security Officer	Student B — Visitor
Your goals: • Acknowledge urgency. • Ask whether the host is expecting the visitor. • Explain that access must be confirmed. • Offer an alternative action. • Avoid arguing or making an unrealistic promise.	Name: Amy Lee Company: Sunrise Computers Host: Mr Raymond Cheung, City Management Appointment: None Reason: "an urgent private matter" Extra challenge: Become mildly impatient after one minute.

Situation Card 3 — Contradictory floor information 情境卡三

Student A — Security Officer	Student B — Visitor
Your goals: • Listen for the contradiction. • Confirm the company and host. • Do not simply send the visitor to either floor. • Explain that you need to verify the location. • Give a professional waiting instruction and update.	Name: Sandy Jones Host: Mr Anthony Lau Company: Tommy Fashion Limited Your email says 23rd floor , but the directory shows 15th floor . Extra challenge: Ask, "Are you sure the directory is up to date?"

Situation Card 4 — Confirmed appointment, missing details 情境卡四

Student A — Security Officer	Student B — Visitor
• Open professionally. • Listen carefully to the details already given. • Ask only for the missing information. • Confirm the visitor's name, company, host, appointment time and floor. • Repeat the key details to check accuracy. • Ask the visitor to wait while you verify the appointment. • Explain the registration, visitor pass and lift procedure. • Close politely.	Name: Kevin Wong Company: Hung Kai Trading Host: Ms Rachel Lee Host's company: City Finance Ltd. Time: 3:30 p.m. Floor: 12th floor Start by saying: "Good afternoon. I have a 3:30 meeting with Rachel Lee at City Finance." Do not give your name, company or floor unless the security officer asks.

Situation Card 5 — An Extra Visitor Is Not on the Appointment 情境卡五

Student A — Security Officer	Student B — Visitor
• Open professionally. • Listen carefully and identify the problem. • Confirm who the appointment is with. • Ask for the second visitor's details. • Do not assume that both visitors can go upstairs. • Explain politely that you need to verify the additional visitor with the office. • Ask them to wait while you check. • Give an update and explain the next step.	Hidden details: Name: Peter Wong Company: Star Trading Ltd. Host: Ms Karen Lee, Prime Finance Time: 11:00 a.m. Floor: 16th floor You have brought a colleague, Mary Chan, with you. Only your name appears on the meeting invitation. Extra challenge: Say, "She's with me. Does she really need to register as well?"

Tips:

"Could I also have your colleague's name, please?"

"Is your colleague attending the same meeting?"

"For security reasons, all visitors need to be registered."

"Would you mind waiting here for a moment while I check?"

"Once registration is complete, we can issue your visitor passes."

Situation Card 6 — Visitor Arrives After Office Hours 情境卡六

Student A — Security Officer	Student B — Visitor
• Open professionally. • Find out who the visitor is here to see. • Confirm whether there is an appointment. • Explain that the tenant's office is already closed. • Do not promise access without confirmation. • Offer a practical next step. • Stay calm if the visitor insists the host is still inside. • Ask the visitor to wait while you check. Problem: It is now 6:40 p.m., and the office normally closes at 6:00 p.m.	Name: Eric Wong Company: Metro Design Ltd. Host: Ms Jenny Chan, Silver Point Consulting Appointment: 6:30 p.m. Floor: 19th floor Start by saying: "Good evening. I'm here for a meeting with Jenny Chan." Extra challenge: Say, "She told me she would still be in the office. Can you just call upstairs?"

Tips:

"I understand. However, the office's normal business hours have already ended."

"The office is normally closed at this time."

"I'm afraid I can't confirm whether Ms Chan is still in the office."

"What I can do is try to contact her office for you."

"Thank you for waiting. I haven't been able to reach the office yet."

"I've received confirmation that Ms Chan is still upstairs."

"Once the visit is confirmed, I can arrange the visitor registration for you."